important differences in views between ourselves and India on the best means of preserving the peace of Asia and the free world." He admitted that these differences resulted in India being "considered one of the most controversial countries insofar as [the administration's FY1956] aid program is concerned." Representative Vorys (R-OH) bluntly asked, "What do we get out of" aiding India? Representative E. Ross Adair (R-IN) asserted that the US should not be as generous with India as with those who were "avowedly our friends." Mutual Security Agency director Harold E. Stassen had to point out that the administration was asking for only a "modest amount." But congressional leaders like Senators Knowland (majority leader) and Bridges (ranking Republican on the Appropriations Committee) argued that even a modest amount was too much, asserting that aid should be reserved for those who substantially cooperated with the US.[220] Eventually, Congress approved only $50 million of the $70 million requested for India.

Concern about such consequences gave India another reason to limit its mediation. Once Eisenhower told Nehru of US agreement to ambassadorial talks in Geneva, the prime minister instructed Krishna Menon to keep his distance from the discussions—something the Indian ambassador in China recommended as well. Nehru did not want either Chinese or US officials to think that India was interfering. Furthermore, he told Krishna Menon that Delhi would handle things from that point.[221] Nehru believed the talks, even if their scope was limited, and the four-power conference in Geneva could lessen tension even if nothing substantive was achieved.[222] He was pleased that the US publicly gave India and Burma credit for the developments, which was in contrast with Washington's having played down India's role a month earlier when Delhi had helped secure the release of the American airmen.[223]

That fall, India did get involved again, but only when Beijing and Washington requested its help with Chinese citizens in the US who wanted to return to China.[224] When the Sino-American talks seemed to stall in October, the Indian ambassador in Washington suggested to Dulles that China and the US consider higher-level talks to discuss larger issues. But Dulles stated that raising the level was not feasible, and Beijing had not taken up the US offer of discussing additional issues. He also questioned the reliability of Chinese promises since nineteen American prisoners